Ex No:2 Setting up a Zoho Creator account and exploring the platform architecture and interface.

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ZOHO CREATOR FEATURES DEMONSTRATION:

Note: the dashed boxes in this record mark where the screenshots from your own Zoho Creator account are to be pasted. The EcoCycle application is used for all examples.

Application:

The **Applications** section is the main workspace in Zoho Creator where custom business applications are created, edited and configured. Its key features are:

- **App creation and dashboard:** new low-code applications can be created from scratch, from templates or from spreadsheets, and existing apps such as the *EcoCycle* e-waste application are managed from one view.
- **Component development:** forms, workflows, reports and dashboards are built and edited here. EcoCycle has three forms (E-Waste Entry, Collection Request, Recycling Tracking), four reports and one dashboard.
- **Access control and publishing:** permissions and roles for an application are set before it is shared with end users.
- **Quick actions:** the More menu gives access to editing, environment settings, sharing, and duplicating or deleting the application.

[Paste your own screenshot here]

Applications page showing the EcoCycle application

Figure: Applications page showing the EcoCycle application

Microservices :

The **Microservices** section is used to build and host connections, data sources, AI models and custom APIs that work together with an application, independently of its forms and reports. Its key features are:

- **Connections:** secure links to other services. EcoCycle uses a Zoho CRM connection so that every collection request creates a lead.
- **Custom API:** logic exposed as an HTTP endpoint. EcoCycle lists the EcoCycle Summary API, a GET endpoint secured with OAuth2.
- **AI models and agents:** AI services that can be called from an application, such as the Zia chat agent used by the EcoCycle Data Assistant.
- **Independent maintenance:** these services can be changed without editing the forms of the application.

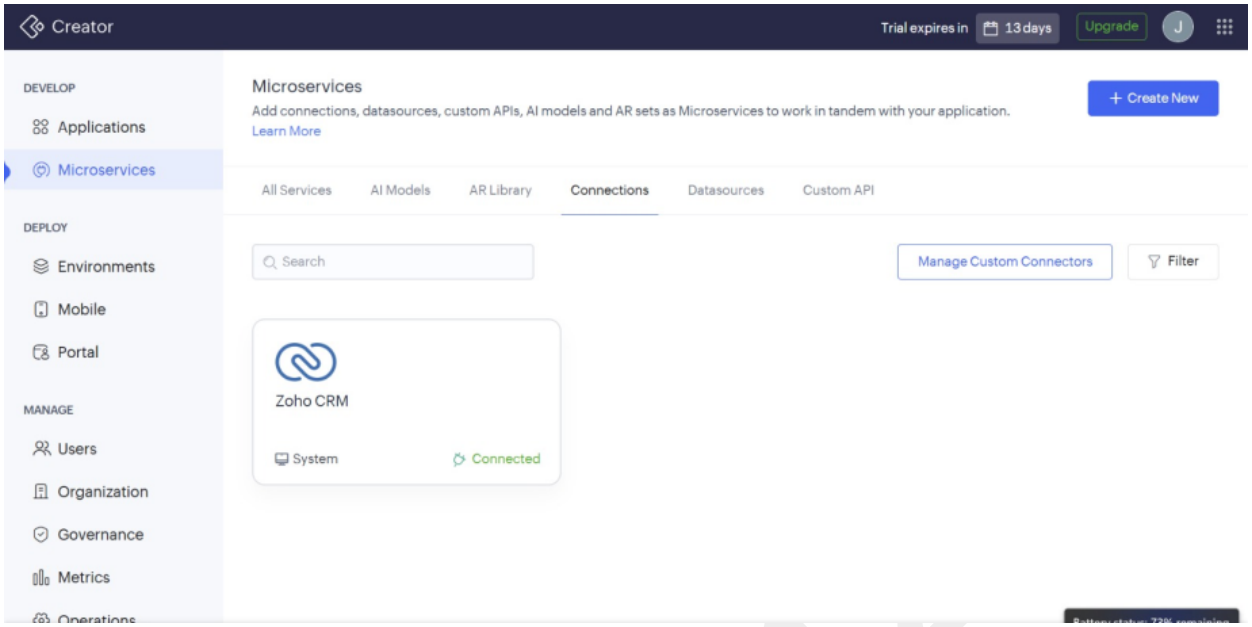


Figure: Microservices page showing the Zoho CRM connection used by EcoCycle

Environments :

The **Environments** feature manages an application across different stages without affecting the live version.

- **Example:** EcoCycle is first changed in Development, tested in Stage to confirm that the priority calculation and the collection request validation work, and then published to Production where staff and requesters use it.
- **Main advantage:** safe development and deployment. New features can be built and tested without disturbing the live application.

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Environments page (Stage and Production columns)

Figure: Environments page (Stage and Production)

Mobile :

The **Mobile** feature lets users open and use Creator applications on smartphones and tablets, anytime and anywhere.

- **Access applications:** EcoCycle can be opened from a phone or tablet.
- **Add and view data:** a collection coordinator can submit an E-Waste Entry or view the Collection Requests report while at the collection site.
- **Mobile-friendly interface:** forms and reports adjust to smaller screens.
- **Device features:** depending on permissions, camera, location and notifications can be used, for example photographing a damaged monitor and attaching it to an entry.

[Paste your own screenshot here]

Mobile page (note any plan limitation shown)

Figure: Mobile page

Portal :

The **Portal** feature gives external users separate, limited access to an application instead of access to the whole Creator account.

- **Example:** E-Waste Administrator → EcoCycle Application → Requester Portal → Requesters. Requesters would submit a collection request and follow its status without seeing other records.
- **Main advantage:** secure external access with control over what each external user can see and do.

[Paste your own screenshot here]

Portal page (note any plan limitation shown)

Figure: Portal page

User :

The **Users** feature manages the people who can use the application and what they may do.

- **Add users** who need to work with the application.
- **Manage access** by deciding which users can open which applications.
- **Assign roles** such as E-Waste Manager, Collection Coordinator or Recycling Officer.
- **Set permissions** so that one user can only view data while another can add, edit or delete it.
- **User** usually means a member of the organisation; a **Portal User** is an external person who reaches selected parts of the application through a portal.

[Paste your own screenshot here]

Users page (All Users list)

Figure: Users page (All Users list)

Organisation :

The **Organisation** feature holds the company details linked to the Creator account and its applications.

- **Organisation details:** basic information such as name, address and time zone.
- **User management:** adding and managing the users of the organisation.
- **Roles and permissions:** defining what different users can access.
- **Organisation-level settings** that apply to all applications.
- **Centralised management** of applications, users and settings in one place.

[Paste your own screenshot here]

Organization page (profile, preferences, branding)

Figure: Organization page

Governance :

The **Governance** feature lets an organisation control and monitor how applications are developed and used, so that they follow its rules and security policies.

- **Control application development** and maintain standards.
- **Manage users and access** so that only authorised people act on applications.
- **Security and compliance:** password policies and multi-factor authentication can be configured.
- **Monitor applications** and their usage.
- **Standardisation** across teams.

[Paste your own screenshot here]

Governance page (Security Policies)

Figure: Governance page (Security Policies)

Metrics :

The **Metrics** feature helps administrators monitor how applications are used and how well they perform.

- Monitor application usage.
- Track performance and spot areas that need improvement.
- Analyse user activity.
- Identify unusual activity or problems.
- Use the collected information for better decisions.

[Paste your own screenshot here]

Metrics page (note any plan limitation shown)

Figure: Metrics page

Operations :

The **Operations** feature gives administrators and developers tools to keep applications running smoothly.

- Monitor applications and their operational status.
- Monitor performance problems that could slow an application.
- Track errors so that they can be investigated and fixed.
- Manage application operations, for example backup, audit trail, logs and e-mail management.
- Troubleshoot problems and take corrective action.

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Operations page

Figure: Operations page

Billing :

The **Billing** feature manages the subscription and payment details of the Creator account or organisation.

- **Manage subscription:** view the plan used by the organisation (EcoCycle was built on a trial edition).
- **Billing information** and **invoices** for the subscription.
- **Payment management** for methods and payments.
- **Plan and usage:** information on the current plan and its usage.
- **Upgrade or downgrade** the plan to suit requirements.

[Paste your own screenshot here]

Billing page (plan details as shown in your account)

Figure: Billing page (subscription and plan details)

Architecture Diagram of Zoho Creator :

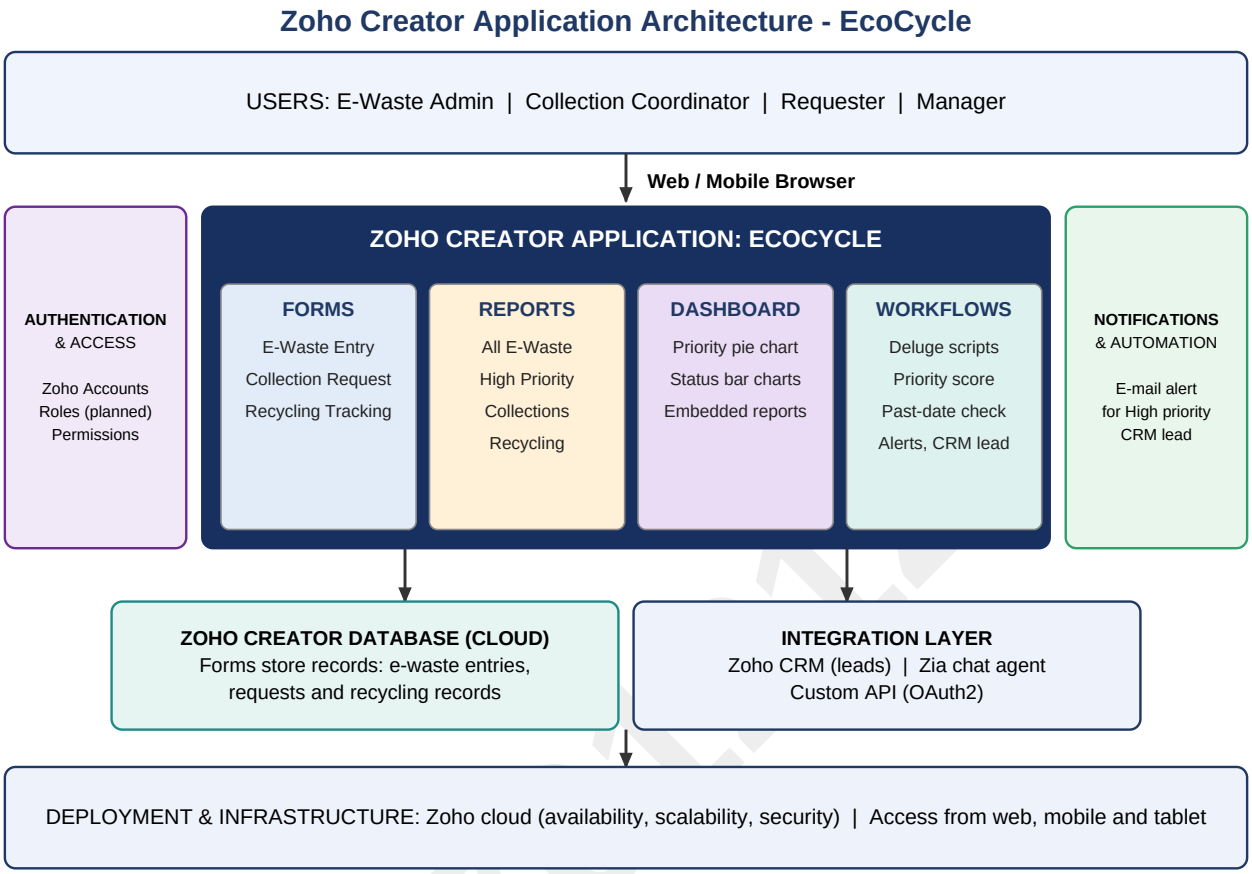


Figure: Zoho Creator application architecture for EcoCycle (conceptual diagram)